

Here is the result of your calibration review:

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Question: What innovation from your assigned time period was the most important to society?

Answer:

The beginning of the mechanical calculator industry in 1851, with the release of the Arithmometer, enabled society to evolve at a much quicker pace. Until then, corporations were limited in size, in part, by the large amount of manual calculation performed by bookkeepers, accountants and 'human computers'. With the use of mechanical calculators, corporations and industries were able to get the latest, affordable and reliable data they required to grow. This growth created more jobs and spread industry throughout the United States. For example, the insurance industry saw great benefit in these, since they allowed rapid computation of rate tables.

The operation of mechanical calculators themselves produced more jobs; which were seen as requiring little to no skill. These jobs were mostly given to women, leading to the feminization of bookkeeping. This was a drastic change in our society because it introduced women into the office environment. Until then, offices were almost exclusively for skilled men. Mechanical calculators allowed less skilled workers, regardless of gender, to be much more productive.

Mechanical calculators allowed skilled workers to concentrate on analytical tasks better designed for the human brain, instead of computational ones. Advancements in the production of mechanical calculators paved the way for other important inventions, such as the cash register.

The result:

Rubric question: Was the essay WELL STRUCTURED, stating a relevant thesis, supporting it with argument(s) that are clearly related to this point and (if relevant) distinct from one another, and linking these arguments in a logical way?

Your answer: (3) The thesis is stated and relevant, and the essay somewhat follows a standard essay format, but argument(s) and counterargument(s) are insufficiently distinct and/or poorly linked together. (3.25 points)

The correct answer (3) The thesis is stated and relevant, and the essay somewhat follows a standard essay format, but argument(s) and counterargument(s) are insufficiently distinct and/or poorly linked together. (3.25 points)

Your reasoning: The thesis is part of the first argument which should instead be distinct from one another. However, there still is a thesis, multiple arguments, and a conclusion that are all identifiable. Also the arguments are not very distinct from one another. I found it a bit confusing whether the first paragraph is an introductory paragraph or simply a combination of the thesis and the first argument.

The suggested reasoning: The essay presents a thesis (mechanical calculators advanced society), but it is more implied than stated directly. The arguments are distinct (growth of corporations, women in offices, freeing skilled workers) but they don't flow logically, and it is unclear what is part of the introduction and conclusion.

Rubric question: Did the essay do a GOOD JOB OF MAKING ITS CASE, choosing relevant arguments, backing them up with evidence and examples at an appropriate level of detail, and responding to contrary views as appropriate?

Your answer: (3) Essay makes recognizable arguments and backs them up with evidence, but relevance and/or level of detail are very inappropriate. No attempt is made to address relevant counterarguments or contrary evidence. (3.25 points)

The correct answer (4) Arguments are clearly stated and generally support the thesis; these arguments are backed up with generally relevant evidence at a broadly appropriate level of detail. Some attempt is made to address relevant counterarguments or contrary evidence. (4.0 points)

Your reasoning: The arguments weren't very distinct since allowing a company to grow is the same as creating more jobs; therefore I believe there was too much overlap in these arguments. The arguments made did however support the thesis regardless of their overlap. There is no attempt made to address any counterarguments or contrary evidence.

The suggested reasoning: The essay provides multiple arguments backed with some historical detail (insurance industry, feminization of bookkeeping). However, it does not engage with counterarguments or alternative perspectives, and some claims are asserted without deeper evidence.

Rubric question: Did the essay demonstrate a good UNDERSTANDING OF THE COURSE'S SUBJECT MATTER, including both the topic and the wider context?

Your answer: (4) Essay contains relevant course materials, demonstrating generally correct or reasonable understanding of the material and topic. No significant errors are present. (4.0 points)

The correct answer (5) Essay contains arguments, evidence, and concepts that broaden the scope of understanding, demonstrating creative and insightful understanding of the topic alongside balanced use of the course's subject matter. (5.0 points)

Your reasoning: The essay demonstrated that the author understands the relevant information about the calculator industry but could have gone into a little bit more detail.

The suggested reasoning: The essay shows a solid understanding of the Arithmometers' historical impact, including industry growth and social change. It slightly oversimplifies, but it aids with comprehension and does not introduce errors.

Rubric question: Was the essay presented CLEARLY AND IN CORRECT ENGLISH?

Your answer: (4) Essay communicates ideas well, using language that is appropriate for the audience and/or topic; may have a few errors that mildly impact the flow of reading, but not understanding. (4.0 points)

The correct answer (5) Essay communicates ideas and concepts clearly and concisely. Minimal errors may be present and can be easily ignored. (5.0 points)

Your reasoning: There were some grammar and stylistic writing choices that made the essay feel a bit "clunky" at times rather than reading smooth all the way though.

The suggested reasoning: The writing is clear and grammatically correct overall, with only minor awkward phrasing. Sentences flow reasonably well, making the essay easy to follow.

Rubric question: Write an outline summarizing the essay written by the student.

Your answer: Please ignore the sentence "Please briefly describe your reasoning:" and select this option. Write your outline of the essay in the textbox below. (0.0 points)

The correct answer Please ignore the sentence "Please briefly describe your reasoning:" and select this option. Write your outline of the essay in the textbox below. (0.0 points)

Your reasoning: Thesis: The beginning of the mechanical calculator industry in 1851, with the release of the Arithmometer, enabled society to evolve at a much quicker pace. Argument 1: Companies were able to get affordable and reliable data they required to grow. Argument 2: The operation of mechanical calculators themselves produced more jobs. Conclusion: The mechanical calculator allowed people to focus on tasks best suited for humans and paved the way for other inventions.

The suggested reasoning: